

II

PART II

The six-phase process

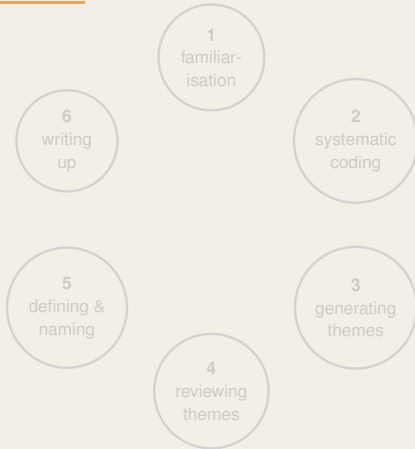
Md. Mehrab Hossain

ID: 2305108

If themes are generated rather than found, what exactly is the work?

Six phases — they are a loop, not a pipeline.

Six phases — and none of them is a one-way street



Six phases, proposed as a way of *doing* analysis and of *learning* to do it.

Six phases — and none of them is a one-way street



Phase 1. Read and re-read. Transcribe yourself if you can. Write familiarisation notes. Do not skim.

Six phases — and none of them is a one-way street



Phase 2. Work through the whole dataset, tagging anything relevant with short, standalone code labels.

Six phases — and none of them is a one-way street



Phase 3. Cluster codes that share meaning into candidate themes. Each needs a central organising concept.

Six phases — and none of them is a one-way street



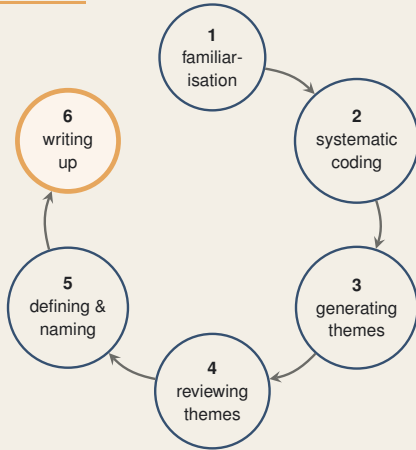
Phase 4. Test candidates twice — against the coded extracts, then against the whole dataset. Split, merge, or discard.

Six phases — and none of them is a one-way street



Phase 5. Write the scope of each theme in two sentences. If you cannot, it is not one theme.

Six phases — and none of them is a one-way street



Phase 6. Writing is analysis. It starts at phase one and never really stops.

Six phases — and none of them is a one-way street



The arrows go both ways. Phase four regularly sends you back to re-code. Byrne calls the six phases “guidelines, rather than rules”.

From one sentence of transcript to one theme

A worked example, after Byrne (2022): interviews with school teachers about promoting student wellbeing.

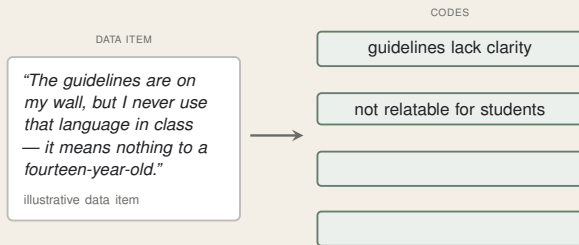
DATA ITEM

“The guidelines are on my wall, but I never use that language in class — it means nothing to a fourteen-year-old.”

illustrative data item

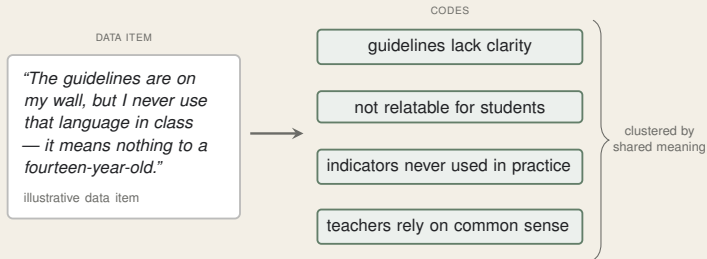
From one sentence of transcript to one theme

A worked example, after Byrne (2022): interviews with school teachers about promoting student wellbeing.



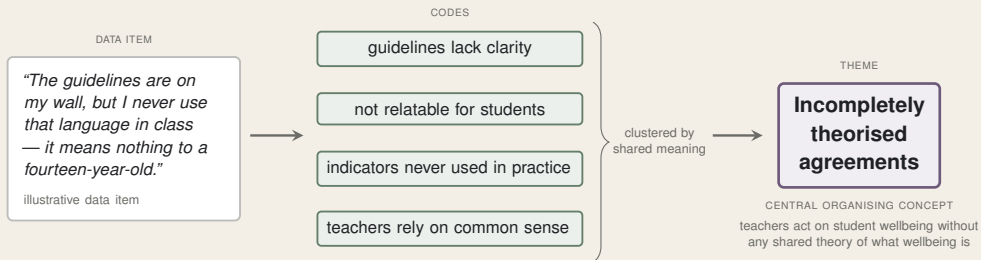
From one sentence of transcript to one theme

A worked example, after Byrne (2022): interviews with school teachers about promoting student wellbeing.



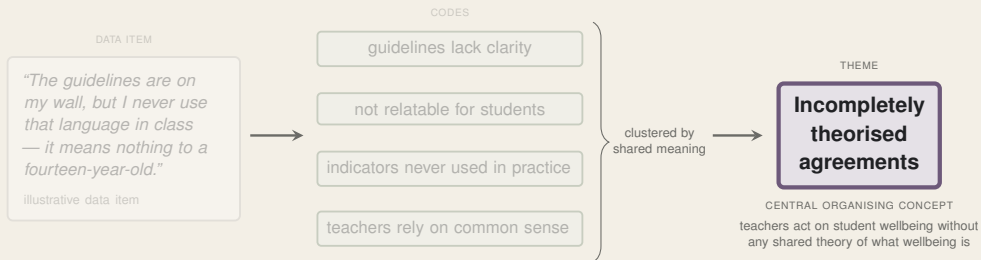
From one sentence of transcript to one theme

A worked example, after Byrne (2022): interviews with school teachers about promoting student wellbeing.



From one sentence of transcript to one theme

A worked example, after Byrne (2022): interviews with school teachers about promoting student wellbeing.



Notice what happened: the theme name is **not a summary of the topic**. It is an interpretation the researcher had to build.

A code is one facet. A theme has many.

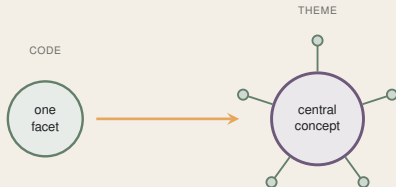
Phase four is where the real work shows.



A theme drawn from a single code is usually still a code.

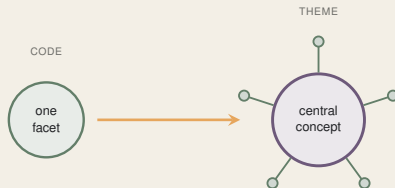
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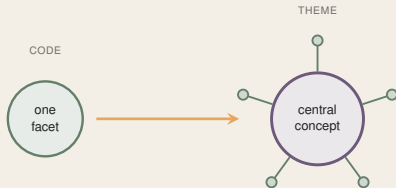
In Byrne's study the initial map had **4 candidate themes**.

One of them was too dense to defend, so it was broken apart and re-interpreted.

The final map had **5 themes** — and three of them did not exist before the review.

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Revision is not a sign of failure. It is the method working.